



Texas Department of Public Safety

Transportation Code Training Program

Guidance for THP Personnel: HB 718 – Temporary Tags and License Plates

Purpose: The Texas Legislature enacted [House Bill 718](#) during the 88th Legislative Session in 2023 to address concerns related to the fraudulent use of paper tags and permits. New laws and associated administrative rules from HB 718 will take effect **July 1, 2025**. The *THP Field Enforcement Guide* will be updated with this information for the August 2025 revision (also incorporating changes from the 2025 legislative session). Meanwhile, department personnel should be guided by information in this document.

Table of Contents (click to follow):

General Overview of Changes

One-Trip and 30-Day Temporary License Plates



Repeal of Buyer's Temporary Tags



Other Sales Circumstances and Temporary License Plates



Dealer Temporary License Plates



Paper Tags and Permits Still in Use



Quick Reference Guide



Resources with Additional Information

General Overview

Effective July 1, 2025, the issuance of these six paper tags and permits will be eliminated:



30-Day Permits



One Trip Permits



Buyer's Tags



Internet Down Tags



Dealer/Converter Temp Tags (Veh. Specific)



Dealer Temp Tags (Authorized Agent)

Temporary tags that were issued prior to 7/1/25 remain valid until their expiration date.

Effective July 1, 2025, the following four new license plates will be implemented:

	Buyer Provisional Plate	For short-term use if dealers lack the required plate type for the vehicle in their inventory.
	Dealer Temporary Plate	For dealers' business-related uses, such as test drives, loaner vehicles, or transporting the vehicle. Personal use of vehicles with these plates is prohibited. The new Dealer Temporary Plate does not replace the current metal dealer license plate, which is permissible for dealers' personal use.
	Out-of-State Buyer Plate	For vehicles sold to out-of-state buyers.
	Temporary Registration Plate	For temporary registration, replacing one-trip and 30-day permits (issued by county tax offices and TXDMV regional service centers).

Source: <https://www.txdmv.gov/HB718>

One-Trip and 30-Day Temporary Registration

This license plate replaces 30-Day and One-Trip permits. It carries the same restrictions previously imposed on these permits.

Expiration will be indicated by a sticker attached to the plate. As soon as the plate is expired, the vehicle should be considered unregistered. Issuance and expiration dates will be available in the TLETS return.



Display

Only one license plate will be issued, and it must be displayed in the rear license plate area according to normal license plate display rules ([DMV Administrative Rule 217.40](#)) A motorcycle version of the license plate will also be available.

Other laws pertaining to obstructed or covered license plates in [504.945](#) apply to these temporary registration license plates.

Other Requirements

The registration receipt must be carried in the vehicle at all times (TRC [502.095](#)).

This plate must be purchased in person at the County Tax Assessor Collector's Office or a TXDMV Regional Service Center.

Vehicles bearing a Texas Temporary Registration license plate are exempt from emissions testing.

Restrictions – One-Trip Temporary Registration

A one-trip temporary registration is good for only one trip from point to point. [DMV Administrative Code Rule 217.40](#) states that the trip must either begin or end in Texas. A one-trip temporary registration may not be valid for more than 15 days. Violation of these provisions means the vehicle is no longer covered by the permit and it should be considered unregistered.

Restrictions – 30-Day Temporary Registration

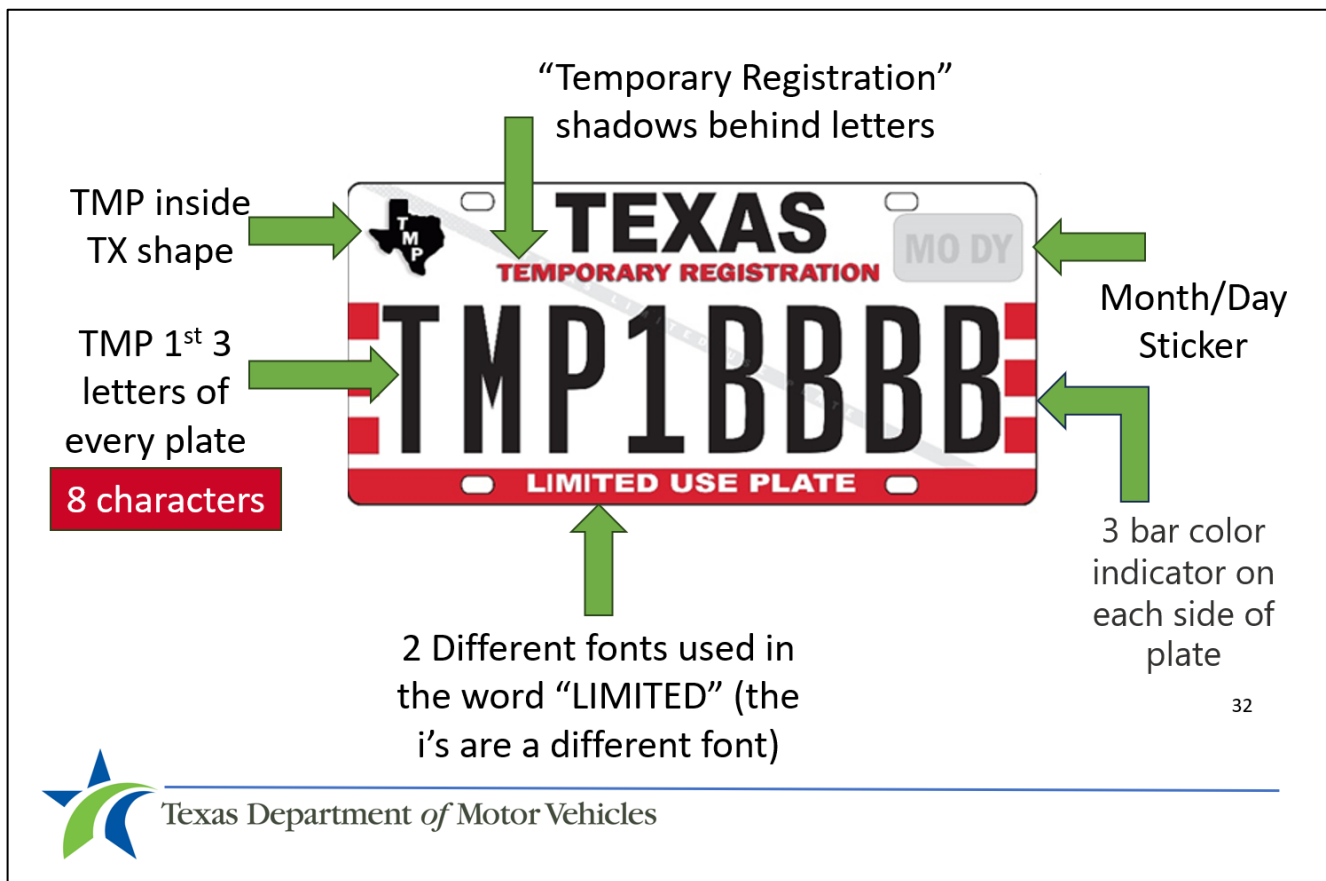
A 30-day temporary registration may not be used on a commercial motor vehicle carrying a load. 30-day registration may only be used for passenger vehicles, private busses, trailers, or semitrailers with a gross weight of not more than 10,000 pounds. If used on a light truck or commercial vehicle with a gross weight of more than 10,000 pounds, the vehicle must be operated unladen. A vehicle displaying a 30-day temporary license plate in violation of these provisions should be considered unregistered.

Paper One-Trip permits should not be valid beyond 7/15/25. Paper 30-Day permits should not be valid beyond 7/30/25. After these dates, only Temporary Registration license plates should be used.

Applicable Arrest Titles:

- Failed to Display Registration Receipt – One Trip or 30-Day License Plate ([502.095](#))
- Improperly Displayed One Trip or 30-Day License Plate ([502.095](#), [504.943](#))
- Display Fictitious License Plate ([504.945](#)) – if fictitious
- Tampering with Governmental Record ([PC 37.10](#)) – if license plate or expiration sticker are falsified
- Display Wrong License Plate ([504.945](#)) – if displayed on vehicle to which it is not assigned
- All obstructed or covered license plate violations described in [504.945](#)
- Operate Unregistered Motor Vehicle/Trailer/Semitrailer ([502.471/72](#)) - once temporary plate expires

Security features of the Temporary Registration license plate:



Source: TXDMV Law Enforcement Module – Metal License Plate Education PowerPoint

Repeal of Buyer's Temporary Tags

Dealers will no longer utilize Buyer's Temporary Tags. Because of the 60 day expiration date, legitimate buyer's tags may be encountered until 8/31/25.

After 7/1/25, when a dealer sells a vehicle, they will attach two general issue metal license plates to the vehicle (standard Texas license plates). This process is described in [503.063](#). If the manufacturer did not provide a feature to which a front license plate can be attached without drilling into the vehicle, the dealer is not required to install the front plate, but the vehicle operator is still required to display front and rear license plates when operating the vehicle on a public highway.

The dealer will apply for registration in the name of the buyer. Upon registration, the windshield insignia will be provided to the buyer by the dealership. The dealer will generally have 30 days to apply for registration on behalf of the buyer (45 days if the vehicle is seller-financed).

The dealer will issue a buyer's receipt. This receipt must be carried in the vehicle until the vehicle's registration is processed and a windshield insignia is issued ([503.0631\(d-2\)](#)). Officers should ask to see this buyer's receipt when a vehicle displays Texas license plates while registration is still pending.

As soon as the registration insignia is received by the buyer, it must be displayed in the lower-left corner of the windshield ([502.059](#)).

All license plate display requirements and obstructed license plate violations apply, as the vehicle is equipped with normal Texas plates as soon as it is sold by the dealer.

At the time of sale, the dealer will make an entry into the DMV Inventory Management System (IMS). Buyer information will return to the license plate number in TLETS so officers can verify recent purchase status roadside. Once registration is processed, a full registration return will appear in the system.

If the dealer's web access system is unavailable at the time of purchase, they will issue two standard Texas license plates to the vehicle and will enter information as soon as access is restored. In this circumstances, the dealer will provide the buyer a form stating why the vehicle is not visible in IMS/TLETS.

Important: License plates will be issued to a vehicle at the time of sale, however the windshield registration insignia will not be available until registration is processed. Officers will encounter newly purchased vehicles that display Texas license plates without a windshield insignia. The license plate return will indicate whether or not registration has been processed. If registration has been processed, an officer has reasonable suspicion to conduct a traffic stop for failure to display registration insignia. If registration has not been processed, the vehicle is not required to display a windshield insignia, and no enforcement action should be taken.

Applicable Arrest Titles:

- Failed to Display Buyer's Receipt – Dealer Issued Plates Pending Registration ([503.0631](#))
- Improperly Placed/Illegible/Unreadable License Plate ([504.943](#))
- Operate Motor Vehicle without License Plates or with One Plate ([504.943](#))
- Display Wrong License Plate ([504.945](#)) – if displayed on vehicle to which it is not assigned
- All obstructed/fictitious/covered license plate violations described in [504.945](#)
- Unauthorized Sale or Distribution of Dealer-Issued License Plates – ([503.0671](#), [503.094](#))



Other Sales Circumstances

Out of State Buyer

If a vehicle buyer lives out-of-state and will not be registering the vehicle in Texas, the dealer will issue an out-of-state buyer license plate.

Only one plate will be provided and display is required in the rear license plate area.

The dealer will issue the buyer a buyer's receipt. This receipt must be carried in the vehicle while the Out of State Buyer license plate is displayed.



This plate is valid for 60 days. Upon expiration, a vehicle should be considered unregistered if no other registration has been obtained. Expiration status will be available in TLETS.

Specialty License Plates

If a buyer registers a vehicle with specialty license plates at the time of purchase (farm plates, disabled veteran, etc.) and the dealer does not have specialty license plates available in inventory, the dealer may issue a Buyer Provisional license plate.

Only one plate will be provided and display is required in the rear license plate area.



The dealer will issue the buyer a buyer's receipt. This receipt must be carried in the vehicle while the Buyer Provisional license plate is displayed ([503.0631\(d-2\)](#)).

This plate is valid until a permanent plate is assigned and expires 7 days after the specialty plates are assigned to the vehicle. This plate is to be returned to the dealer in exchange for the permanent specialty plates and corresponding windshield insignia.

Applicable Arrest Titles:

- Failed to Display Buyer's Receipt – Dealer Issued Plates Pending Registration ([503.0631](#))
- Improperly Placed/Illegible/Unreadable License Plate ([504.943](#))
- Display Fictitious License Plate ([504.945](#)) – if fictitious
- Display Wrong License Plate ([504.945](#)) – if displayed on vehicle to which it is not assigned
- All obstructed or covered license plate violations described in [504.945](#)
- Operate Unregistered Motor Vehicle/Trailer/Semitrailer ([502.471/72](#)) (once temporary plate expires)
- Unauthorized Sale or Distribution of Dealer-Issued License Plates – ([503.0671](#), [503.094](#))

Dealer Temporary License Plates

The Dealer Temporary license plate replaces all paper dealer temp tags, including Dealer Vehicle Specific tags, Authorized Agent tags, and Converter tags.

The restrictions imposed on paper dealer temporary tags are transferred to Dealer Temporary license plates.



Display

Only one license plate will be issued, and it must be displayed in the rear license plate area. [DMV Administrative Rule 215.138](#) (effective 7/1/25) requires display according to DMV rules for license plates. A motorcycle version of the license plate will also be available.

Plate expiration will be indicated by stickers attached to the plate and valid dates will correspond with the dealership's GDN license expiration. A vehicle displaying an expired Dealer Temporary license plate should be considered unregistered.

Approved uses:

- Vehicle demonstration to prospective buyer
- Transit dealer to dealer, to/from auction, to/from repair facility
- Road test the vehicle
- Vehicle used by a charitable organization
- Loaner vehicle to customer while customer's vehicle is being repaired

Prohibited uses:

- Personal use by a dealer or employees
- On a vehicle that has been sold to a buyer
- On a rental or leased vehicle
- On a laden commercial vehicle

Other Requirements

The registration receipt must be carried in the vehicle at all times ([DMV Administrative Rule 215.138](#), effective 7/1/25).

The vehicle title must be in the name of or assigned to the dealership.

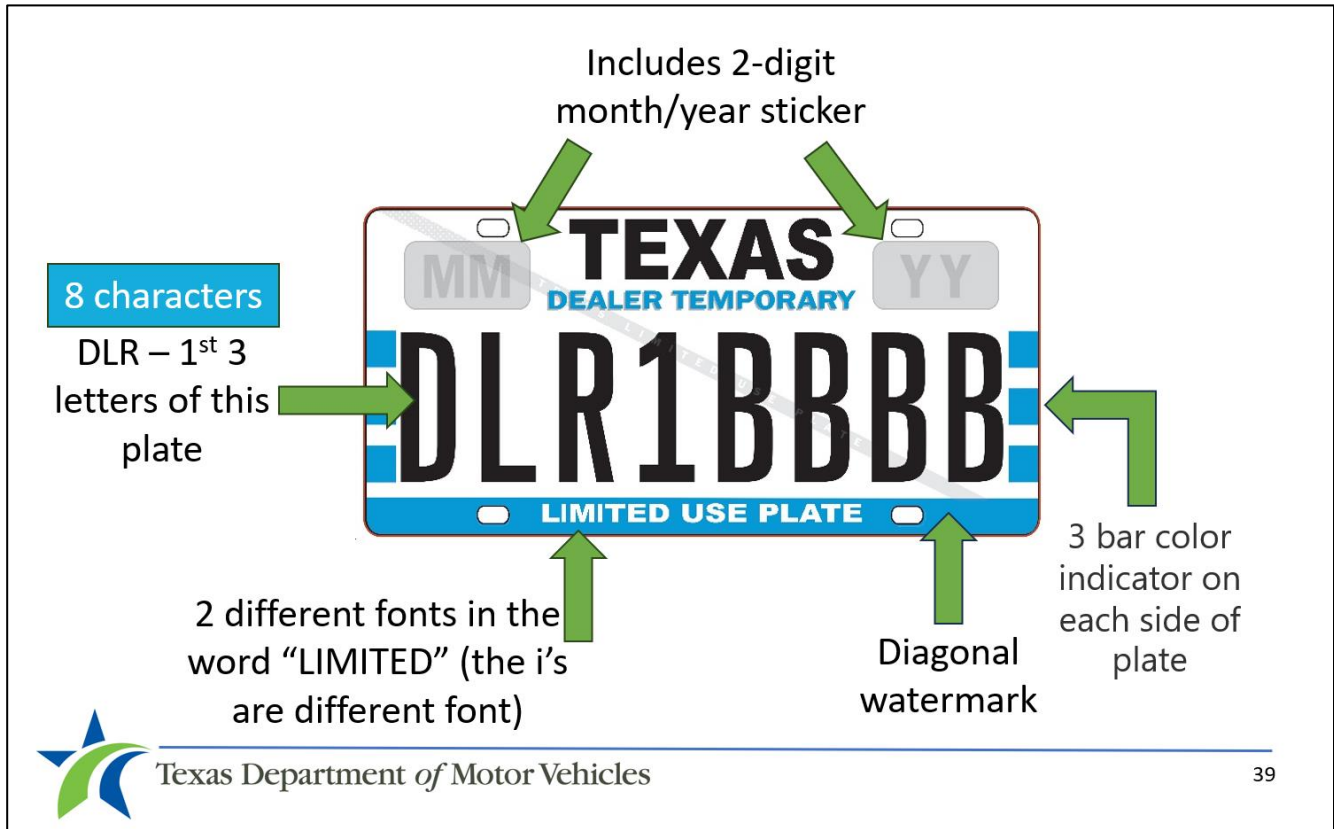
Applicable Arrest Titles:

- Improper Use of Dealer Temporary Plate ([503.062](#), [503.0671](#))
- Improperly Displayed Dealer License Plate ([503.069](#), [504.943](#))
- Failed to Display Registration Receipt – Dealer Temporary License Plate ([503.062](#))
- Improperly Placed/Illegible/Unreadable License Plate ([504.943](#))
- Display Fictitious License Plate ([504.945](#)) – if fictitious
- All obstructed or covered license plate violations described in [504.945](#)
- Unauthorized Sale or Distribution of Dealer-Issued License Plates – ([503.0671](#), [503.094](#))
- Operate Unregistered Motor Vehicle/Trailer/Semitrailer ([502.471/72](#)) (once temporary plate expires)

Note: Non-temporary metal dealer license plates will still be utilized, and their use was not affected by HB 718.



Security features of the Dealer Temporary license plate:



Source: TXDMV Law Enforcement Module – Metal License Plate Education PowerPoint

Paper Tags and Permits Still in Use

Although most paper tags and permits were repealed by [HB 718](#), the following paper permits will remain in use:



72-Hour permit



144-Hour permit



Texas Temporary Insignia – issued when a vehicle is assigned personalized or specialty plates (e.g. Disabled Veteran plates, Personalized license plate numbers, etc.) Utilized until the owner receives the personalized plates from the DMV.

VEHICLE TRANSIT PERMIT RECEIPT	
PERMIT NO: 0378Y4	DATE: 02/23/2025
APPLICANT NAME AND ADDRESS	START DATE: 02/23/2025 EXPIRATION DATE: 02/26/2025
ABC AUTO	
1234 ANYWHERE	
AUSTIN, TX 79999	
ORIGINATION POINT	
AUSTIN	
INTERMEDIATE POINT(S) (IF APPLICABLE)	
DESTINATION POINT	
AUSTIN	
VEHICLE IDENTIFICATION NO: 1F800032X582B99999	
YR/MAKE: 1999/FORD	BODY STYLE: LL
TITLE/DOCUMENT NUMBER:	99924037523142999
RECEIPT FOR PERMIT MUST BE CARRIED IN THE VEHICLE AT ALL TIMES.	
THIS PERMIT IS VALID FOR 5 CALENDAR DAYS.	
YOU MUST GO TO YOUR LOCAL COUNTY TAX OFFICE TO TITLE AND REGISTER YOUR VEHICLE WITHIN 30 DAYS FROM DATE OF SALE.	

Vehicle Transit Permit Receipt – used in private party sales where seller retains license plates. Valid for one trip from point of origin to destination. Valid for 5 days and may be purchased online and printed.

Quick Reference Guide

GENERAL ISSUE PLATE	DEALER METAL PLATE	DEALER TEMPORARY PLATE	OUT-OF-STATE BUYER	BUYER PROVISIONAL PLATE	TEMPORARY REGISTRATION PLATE
Issued to a retail purchaser at time of sale by Dealer Must keep purchase receipt in vehicle until registered Dealer is required to submit title transaction in WebDealer within 30 calendar days of the date of sale or 45 calendar days if seller financed Must be properly secured in front and rear plate holders Dealer required to enter buyer information in IIMS linked to TLETS Must have current emissions inspection if applicable	Permitted Uses: 1. Vehicle demonstration and personal use 2. Transit from dealer, auction, mechanic, or body shop, etc. 3. May be used on a loaner vehicle for customers 4. Vehicle used by charitable organization Only one plate is issued. Must be displayed in rear plate holder Cannot be displayed on a commercial vehicle carrying a load Title must be in name of or assigned to dealership Must have current emissions inspection if applicable Cannot display signs on vehicle	Permitted Uses: 1. Vehicle demonstration 2. Transit from dealer, auction, mechanic, or body shop, etc. 3. May be used on a loaner vehicle for customers 4. Vehicle used by charitable organization Cannot be used by dealership personnel for personal use Only one plate is issued. Must be displayed in rear plate holder Cannot be used for carrying a load unless vehicle is carrying another vehicle with a dealer temporary plate to or from a point of sale Valid until the next renewal of the dealer's license. Dealer will need to request renewal stickers.	Replaces buyer temp tag Provided to Out-of-State Buyers Cannot be used for export sales Only one plate is issued. Must be displayed in rear plate holder Valid for 60 days Issue and expiration dates available in RTS and TLETS	Same use as general issue metal plate Used if buyer needs a plate type not in dealer's plate inventory Not used for export sales Only one plate is issued. Must be displayed in rear plate holder Valid until a permanent plate is assigned (expires 7 days after assignment) Issue and expiration dates available in RTS and TLETS Must have current emissions inspection if applicable	Replaces the 30-Day and One-Trip Permits Must be purchased at a RSC or TAC office To be used for export sales Must be displayed in rear plate holder Must purchase in person and have valid insurance Exempt from emissions inspection Valid between 15-30 days depending on its use Valid for travel that begins or ends in Texas



Resources for Additional Information

Texas DMV website about HB 718 implementation: <https://www.txdmv.gov/HB718>

DMV Administrative Rules Chapter 215 Changes (effective 7/1/25): [Click to View](#)

DMV Administrative Rules Chapter 217 Changes (effective 7/1/25): [Click to View](#)

Texas Department of Motor Vehicles Law Enforcement Assistance Team (LEAT)

Phone: (512) 465-1243

E-mail: ENF_LE_Assist@txdmv.gov

Website: [Click to View](#)

Texas Department of Public Safety Transportation Code Training Program Resource Page:

<https://txdpstrafficlaw.com/resources/>

Additional questions may be directed to Sgt. Scott Hewitt – scott.hewitt@dps.texas.gov